

AUTHOR'S NOTE

I was born in Orakzai, a place where mountains, community, tradition, and memory are deeply connected. My understanding of identity began long before I understood the language of history.

"I'm Orakzai" is an attempt to explore that connection.



This book brings together the history and heritage of the Orakzai and the wider Pashtun world with questions about the present and the future. It looks at the traditions that shaped generations, the changes experienced by our communities, and the opportunities created by education, technology, entrepreneurship, and a rapidly changing world.

I wrote this book not only to look backward, but also to look forward.

Our history deserves to be remembered carefully. Our traditions deserve to be documented responsibly. And our younger generations deserve the opportunity to build something new without losing the connection to where they came from.

For me, being Orakzai is not only a statement of ancestry. It is a responsibility to understand our past, respect those who came before us, and contribute something meaningful to those who come after us.

The journey from the mountains of Orakzai to the world of modern technology may seem like two different stories. To me, they are connected by the same idea:

Know your roots. Build your future.

— Faisal Orakzai

